STATE SCAN

UTTAR PRADESH: NETA VS BABU TOURNAMENT *PG 18* | **KARNATAKA: A RICH LATHER** *PG 22*



ACCUSED NO. 1

- **MONOJIT MISHRA,** 31, prime accused in the Kasba rape, is an ex-student of South Calutta Law College and informally headed its TMC student unit
- He has been in numerous scraps with the law. In the last 12 years 11 cases were registered against him; he was arrested five times
- In 2017, he was arrested for violence in Kalighat. In 2019, he faced a theft charge and was accused of assaulting a woman inside the same union room where the present assault began. In 2022 came a molestation case. In 2024, he was reported for assaulting a guard
- Shockingly, he was appointed as a casual staffer after a governing body recommendation
- Trinamool MLA Ashok Kumar Deb, who chairs the governing body, denies direct involvement. But Monojit's social media accounts are filled with photographs with senior TMC leaders

▶ WEST BENGAL

A NEW SHAME FOR TMC

Another horrible rape rocks Kolkata. That the prime accused is with the TMC surprises no one, fuelling protests across the city

By **Arkamoy Datta Majumdar**

ANOTHER VIOLENT MALE predator, another victim. A symbolic pairing, but also a very real one, it restores to Kolkata the dark shadows cast over it by the chilling rape-cum-murder at R.G. Kar Medical College and Hospital last August. On June 25, the South Calcutta Law College at Kasba saw a near-replay. Talk is again about the links of the accused to power. Outraged Kolkatans are again protesting. The state assembly election is a year closer, so the air is again thick with politics. The lucky piece of divergence: the victim lives to tell the tale.

It had unfolded like any other term-day for the 24-year-old—deceptively ordinary. She reached campus past noon, filled up her first-sem exam forms, went to the common room for a spot of rest. That's when Monojit Mishra entered. All of 31, ex-student and omnipresent lout, with a history of sexual bullying and all-purpose goonery but immune to disciplining or banishment because, as the girl's complaint letter described it, he's officially part of the college and, "unofficially", the head of its TMCP (Trinamool Chhatra Parishad) unit—so he "holds much power...everyone listens to him".

THE MALEFACTOR

That day, he was distributing student portfolios—she was anointed the new "girls' secretary". Later, as classes emptied and corridors thinned around 4 pm, the outgoing girls' secretary headed her off with a trail of desultory small talk that led back to the common room. Here, Monojit and his retinue joined in. It was a web of subtle menace, which